

Session 1 : Introduction to Artificial Intelligence

Welcome to your AI journey! Today we explore what Artificial Intelligence really means and discover how it's already a part of your daily life, from the shows you watch to the apps you use.

Get ready to explore the world of AI 🚀





Today's Objective

By the end of this session, you will be able to:

1

Define AI

Say what AI is in your own words

2

Spot AI Around You

Find AI in apps and devices you already use

3

Sense → Think → Act

Explain the core idea behind how AI works

4

Myth vs. Reality

Tell what's true and what's a myth about AI

5

AI is a Tool

Understand that AI is a tool - not a person

What Do You Already Know About AI?

Let's just talk for a minute. No wrong answers.

First Thoughts

When you hear "Artificial Intelligence" - what's the first thing that pops into your head?

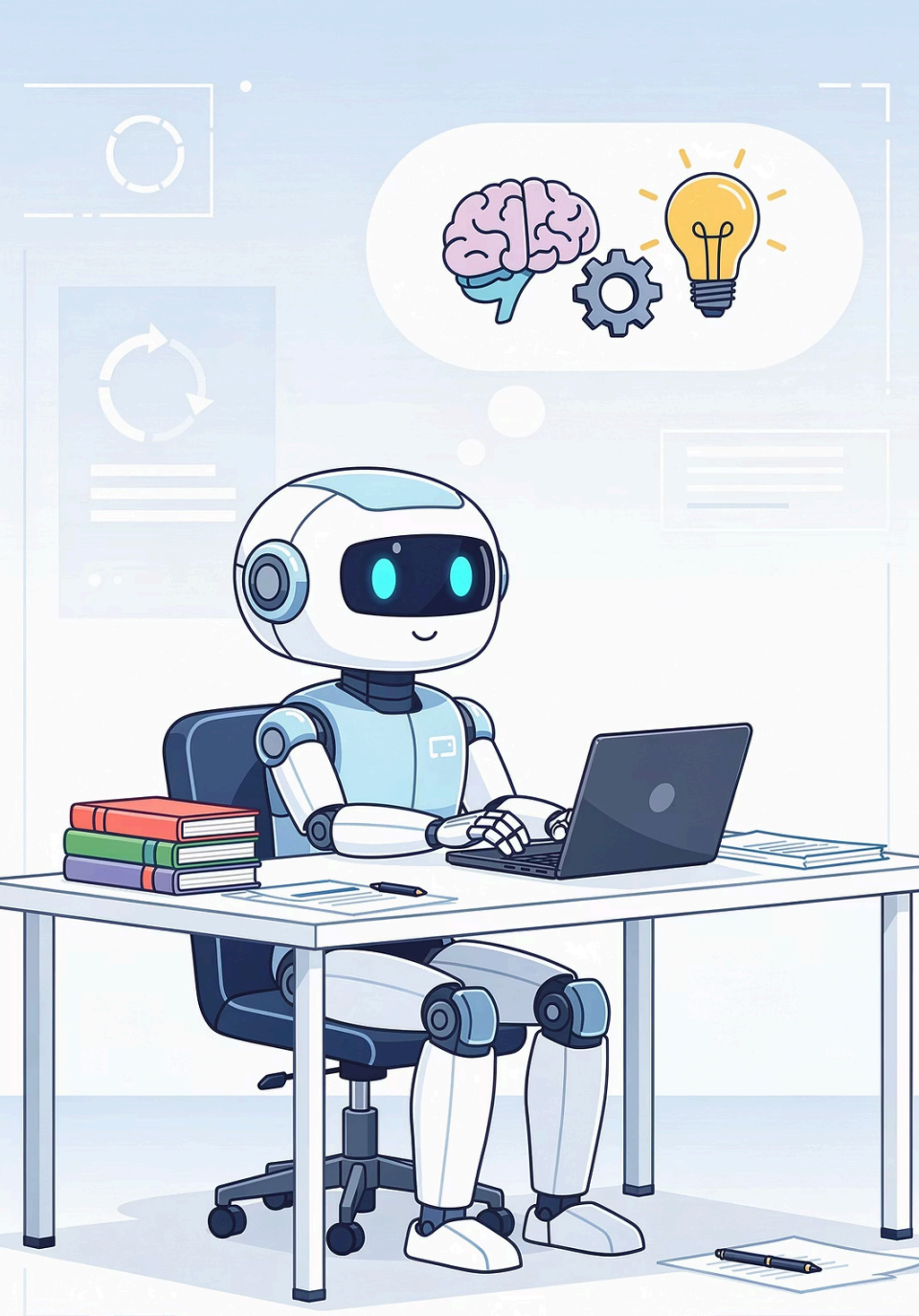
Your Experience

Have you ever used an app or a device that felt like it *knew* what you wanted?

Your Question

What's one question you have about AI?





What is Artificial Intelligence?

AI is when computers do things that usually need a human brain.

These tasks include:



Learning

Getting better with practice, just like you do



Spotting Patterns

Noticing what looks the same or different



Understanding Words

When you talk or type to it



Making Choices

Picking the best option from many



Making New Stuff

Pictures, stories, songs - all generated by AI

AI Learns from Examples - Not Magic

Here's the secret: AI isn't magic. It learns from examples. Imagine you want to teach a computer what a cat looks like:

1

Show It

You show it **thousands** of cat pictures

2

It Notices

The computer spots what's the same - pointy ears, whiskers, a tail

3

It Guesses

Show it a new picture - it says: "Yep, that's a cat!"

- ❑ The computer doesn't actually **KNOW** what a cat is. It has never pet a cat. It just sees patterns in pictures.



AI vs. Traditional Programs

What makes AI different from a regular computer program?

Traditional Programs

- Follows rules a person wrote
- Always does the exact same thing
- Like a calculator: $2 + 2 = 4$, every single time

AI-Powered Systems

- Learns from examples
- Gets better over time
- Like a spam filter: gets smarter the more emails it sees

 **The big idea:** Regular programs follow instructions. AI figures things out.

Mini Activity 1: AI in Your Day

Let's find AI in **YOUR** life. Which of these have you used today or this week?



YouTube / Netflix

Suggests what to watch next - *learns what you like*



Siri / Google Assistant / Alexa

Voice assistants - *understands your voice*



Face Unlock on Smartphones

Recognises YOUR face specifically (*knows it's you, not someone else*)



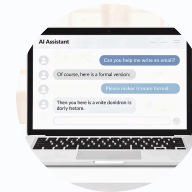
Google Maps

Predicts traffic and finds the fastest route (*learns the roads*)



Instagram / Snapchat

Filters that follow your face - *sees where your face is*



ChatGPT / Gemini

Generates answers to anything - *the newest wave of AI*

 Which ones surprised you? Which do you use the most?

How Did We Get Here? The Quick Story

AI isn't new. People have been working on it for over 70 years! Here are the three biggest moments.



1950 - The Big Question

British scientist Alan Turing asked: "*Can machines think?*" Nobody knew - but that question kicked off the whole field of AI.



1997 - Everyone Freaked Out

A computer called Deep Blue beat the world chess champion. A machine just out-thought the best chess player on Earth!



Today - AI Everywhere

AI can write stories, make pictures, have conversations, and help with homework. It's in your phone, your TV, your music apps - everywhere.

You are living through the most exciting time in AI history.

What people are building right now would have seemed like magic just 5 years ago.

AI is Smart - But Not Like You

AI can do amazing things. But it's very different from a human brain.

You Can:

- Learn from just one example
- Feel things - happy, sad, excited, nervous
- Use common sense (drop a glass = it breaks)
- **Be truly creative** - come up with ideas nobody has ever had before

AI Can:

- Process huge amounts of information super fast
- Spot patterns humans would miss
- Work 24/7 without getting tired
- **"Create" by remixing** - combines patterns from everything it's seen
- Sounds like it cares - but feels nothing

- ❏ When you draw a picture or write a story, you're making something that has never existed before. When AI makes a picture, it's blending millions of pictures it already saw. That's a huge difference - and it's your superpower.

The Calculator Idea

Here's something surprising about AI: it can give you an answer in less than a second... but it doesn't actually *understand* the answer it gave you.

Think about a calculator. You type 45×22 and it instantly tells you 990. But the calculator has no idea what those numbers *mean*. It doesn't know if you're counting cookies or measuring stars. It just spits out a result.

AI Can:

Write a poem
about your dog

Without knowing what a
dog is

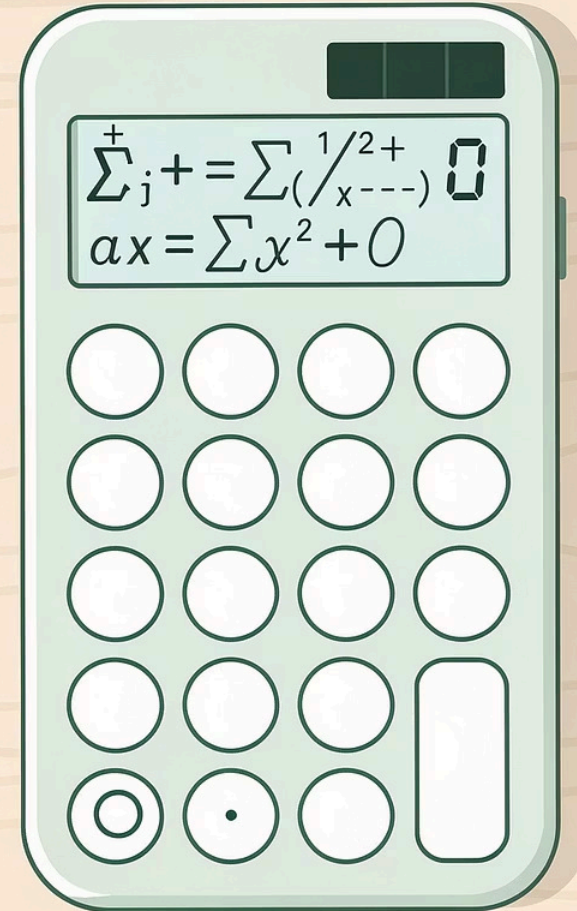
Answer a question
about pizza

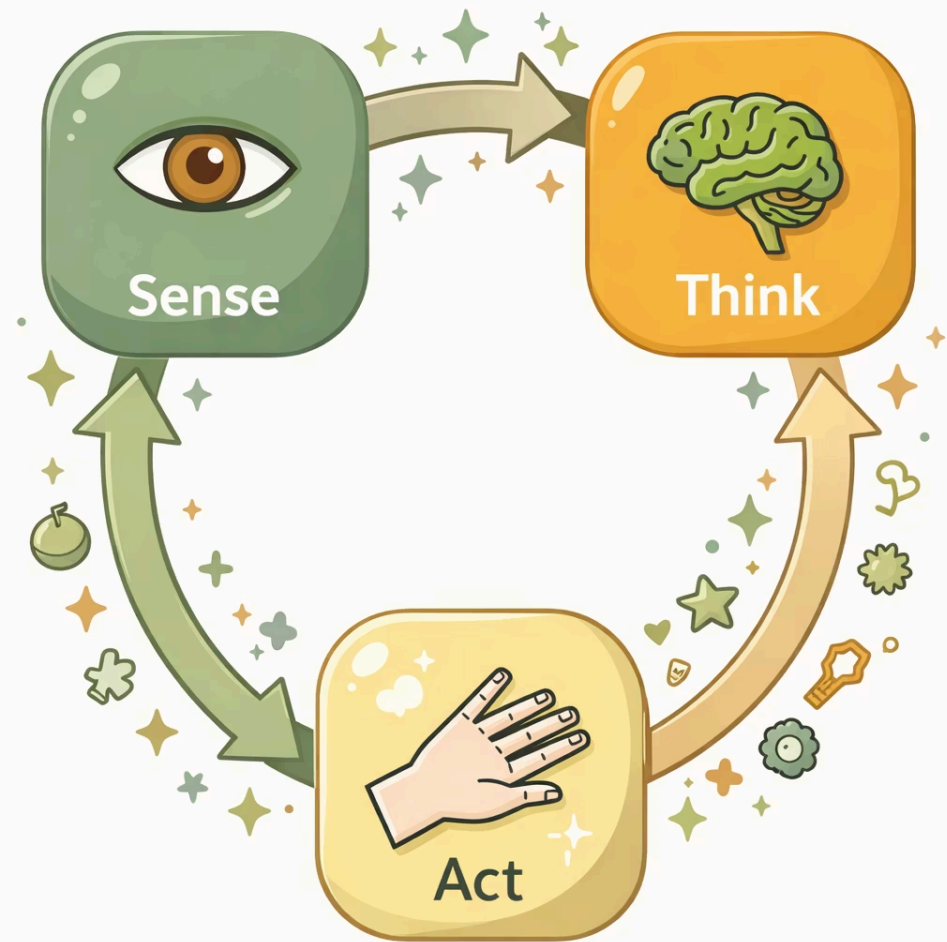
Without ever tasting one

Explain how
sadness feels

Without ever feeling
anything

⚠️ **That's why we always double-check AI.** It can be confidently wrong
- and it won't even know it was wrong.





How AI Works: Sense → Think → Act

Every AI system does three things - no matter what kind it is.

SENSE

Take in information from the world around it

THINK

Figure out what to do with that information

ACT

Do something with the answer it figured out

☑ That's the whole pattern. **Every AI uses it** - from Siri to self-driving cars to Netflix recommendations.

SENSE: How AI Takes In Information

AI needs to gather information before it can do anything. It uses:



Cameras - to See

Face unlock, Snapchat filters

AI uses cameras to see the world visually



Sensors - to Feel

Smart thermostats, fitness trackers - AI senses temperature, movement, and more



Microphones - to Hear

Siri, Alexa

AI listens to your voice and converts it to data



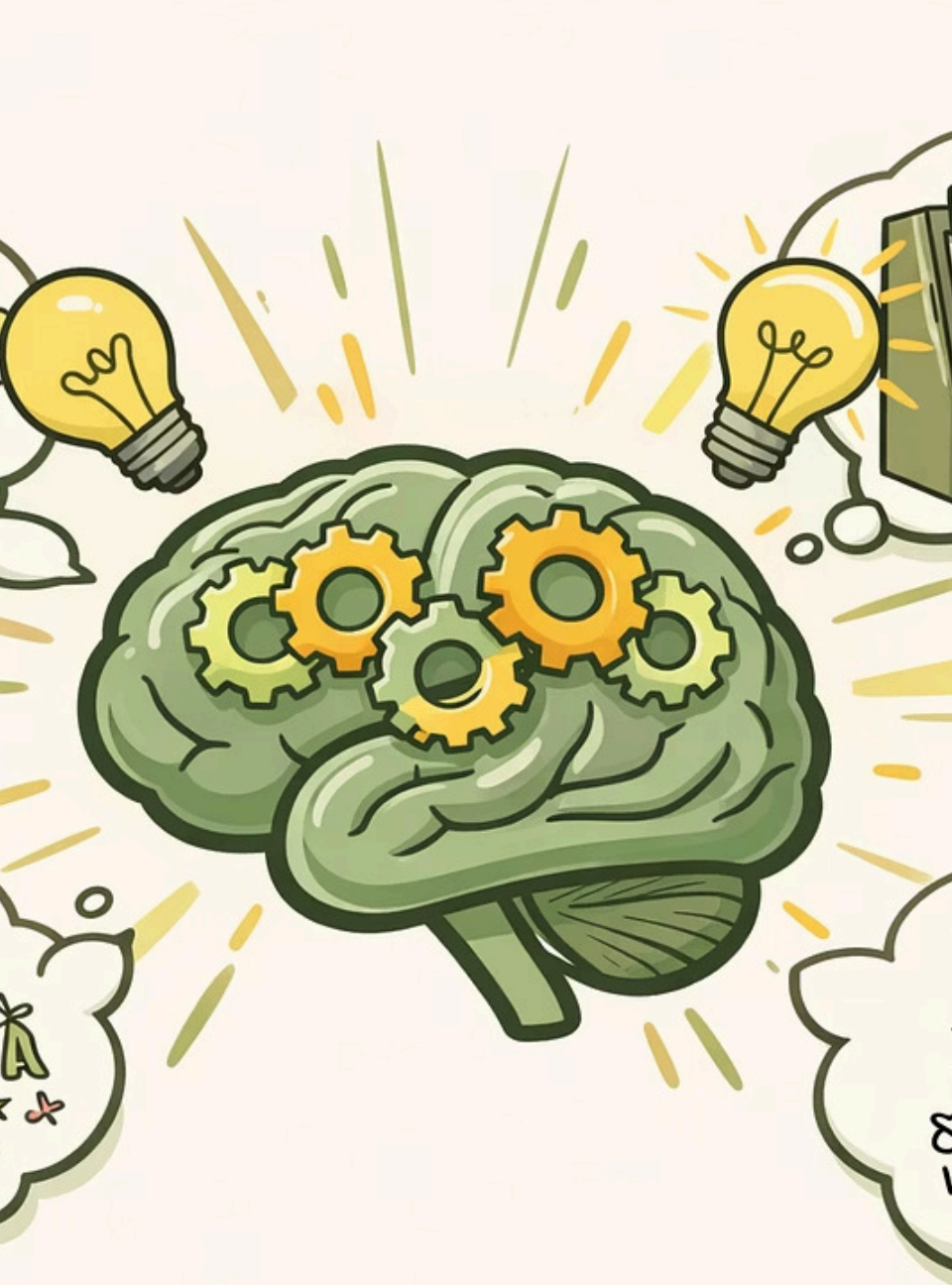
What You Type - to Read

ChatGPT, Google Search -

AI reads your words as input

❶ This is just the input - like AI's eyes, ears, and fingertips.





THINK: How AI Figures Things Out

Once AI has the information, it has to figure out what to do. This is the "brain" part - except it's all math, not real thinking.

Spot Patterns

"Is that a cat or a dog?" - AI compares what it sees to everything it learned

Make Guesses

"What video will this person like next?" - AI predicts based on past behavior

Make Choices

"Should the car stop or keep going?" - AI picks the best action in real time

Create Things

"Let me write a poem about pizza" - AI generates new content from patterns

ACT: What AI Does With the Answer

Finally, AI does something with what it figured out. The action can take many forms:



Show You Text

An answer on screen - like ChatGPT responding to your question



Speak Out Loud

Like Siri's voice reading you the weather forecast



Recommend Something

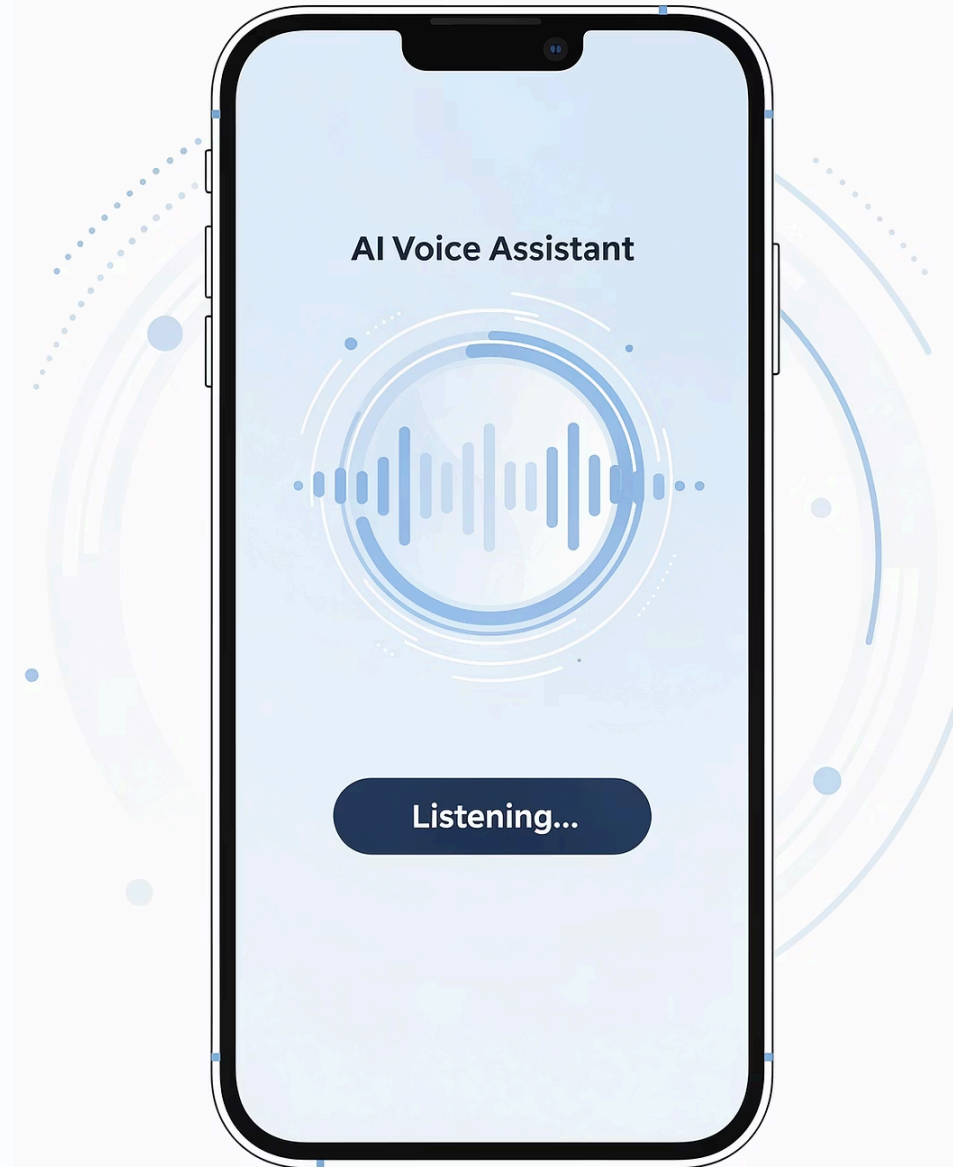
Like Netflix suggesting a show on your home screen

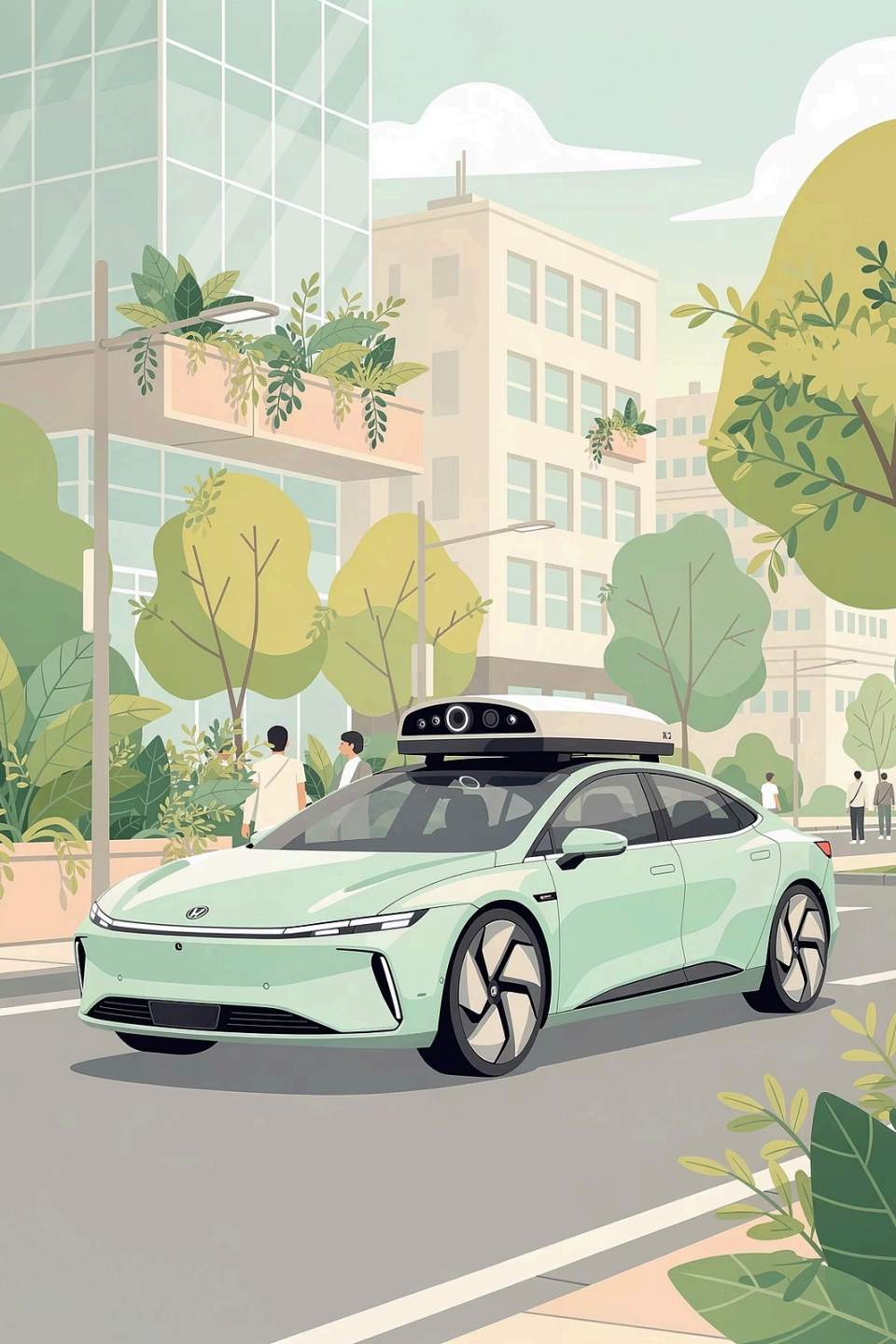


Move

Like a robot or a self-driving car steering and braking

📄 **Sense → Think → Act.** That's the whole pattern - every time, every AI.





Sense → Think → Act in Real Life

Let's see this in action. Here are three AI things you've probably seen or used - watch how each one follows the same pattern.

Siri / Alexa

SENSE: Microphone hears you say "What's the weather?"

THINK: Turns your voice into text, figures out you want weather, looks it up

ACT: Speaks the answer out loud

Netflix Recommendations

SENSE: Notices what shows you've watched and finished

THINK: Compares your taste to millions of other people

ACT: Shows you "Top Picks for You" on the home screen

Self-Driving Car

SENSE: Cameras and sensors watch the road, other cars, people

THINK: Decides - should I stop? Turn? Speed up?

ACT: Brakes, steers, or accelerates

❓ Try it yourself: Pick any app on your phone. Can you spot the Sense → Think → Act?

Mini Activity 2: AI or Not AI?

Let's play a game. For each item below - is it AI or not AI? Think about it before you look at the answers!

Thing	AI or Not AI?
A calculator	🤔 ?
Netflix suggesting a movie	🤔 ?
A traffic light on a timer	🤔 ?
Google Maps predicting traffic	🤔 ?
A microwave with preset buttons	🤔 ?
Snapchat filter that follows your face	🤔 ?

🔒 Think carefully before flipping to the next slide for answers!



AI or Not AI? - Answers

Thing	Answer	Why
Calculator	Not AI	Same rules every time - no learning
Netflix suggestions	AI	Learns from what you watch
Traffic light on timer	Not AI	Just a timer - no learning
Google Maps traffic	AI	Learns from real-time data from millions of phones
Microwave buttons	Not AI	Same preset every time
Snapchat face filter	AI	Sees and tracks your face in real time

① If it learns and gets better, it's probably AI.

If it does the exact same thing every time, it's probably not.

AI Myths: What's True and What's Not

There's a lot of wild stuff people say about AI. Let's clear up the big ones.



- MYTH: "AI is just robots."

REALITY: AI is software - code. Most AI lives quietly on your phone or in the cloud, not in a robot body.

- MYTH: "AI will take over the world."

REALITY: Real AI doesn't *want* anything. It has no goals, no plans, no feelings. A chess AI doesn't even know it's playing chess - it's just doing math.

- MYTH: "AI is always right."

REALITY: AI makes mistakes - sometimes really confident-sounding wrong answers. Always double-check important stuff.

- MYTH: "AI has feelings."

REALITY: AI can sound like it cares. It doesn't actually feel anything. It's all math.

Two Types of AI

Scientists talk about two types of AI - and only one of them actually exists today.

🎯 Narrow AI

The only kind that actually exists

- Can do ONE specific thing really well
- Examples: chess AI, face unlock, ChatGPT, Snapchat filters
- Every AI you've ever used is this kind

💡 General AI

Doesn't exist yet - only in movies

- Could do ANYTHING a human can do
- Cook, drive, paint, do math, play sports - all of it
- Maybe someday. Not yet.

- ① Narrow AI is like a master chef who can cook ANY dish - but only in the kitchen. Move them to a garage to fix a car? Totally lost. General AI would be like a person who can cook AND fix cars AND teach math AND play soccer.





AI is a Tool - Not a Replacement

This might be the most important idea in the whole course.

🔧 AI helps you brainstorm.
You decide what's good.

🔧 AI suggests ideas.
You pick the right one.

🔧 AI writes a draft.
You make it yours.

🔧 AI gives you an answer.
You check if it's true.

✅ No matter what AI does - **YOU are the one in charge. YOU are responsible.**

Hands-On Activity: Meet Google Storybook

Now let's actually use AI together.

Today's tool: **Google Storybook** 📖

01

You Give It an Idea

Start with any opening sentence - anything you want!

03

You Guide the Story

Tell the AI what should happen next - you're the director

02

AI Adds the Next Part

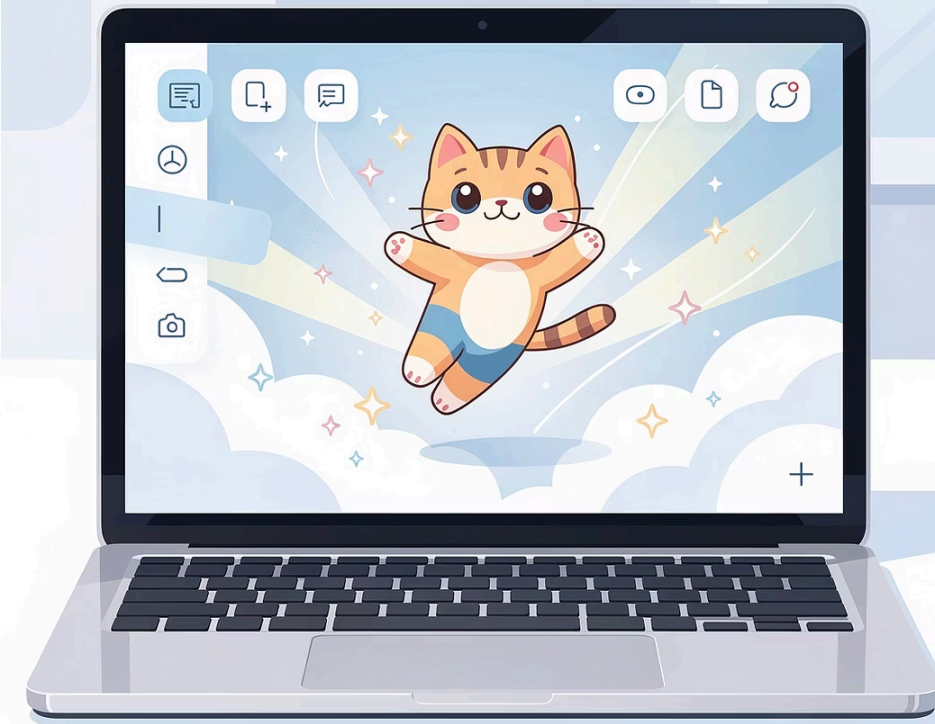
The AI continues the story based on your beginning

04

Together, You Create

You make something neither of you could make alone

📋 Ready? Let's go!



Hands-On: Build a Story Together

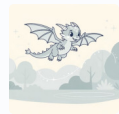
Steps to follow:

- 1 Open Google Storybook**
Launch the tool on your device
- 2 Type a Fun Opening Sentence**
Anything you want - be creative!
- 3 Watch the AI Add the Next Part**
See how it continues your story
- 4 Tell the AI What Happens Next**
You guide where the story goes
- 5 Keep Going Until It's Complete**
Build a full story together!

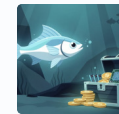
Try one of these openers if you're stuck:



"Once upon a time, there was a robot who loved to dance."



"In a magical forest, a young dragon learned to fly."



"Deep in the ocean, a curious fish found a glowing treasure."



Look What You Did!

You just used AI to create something brand new. Notice three things:

AI Needed You

The AI couldn't have made the story without you. **Your ideas were the spark.**

AI Helped You

You couldn't have made it that fast without the AI. **It helped speed things up.**

The Story is Yours

You guided it. You chose what to keep. **You're the author.**

- ☑ That's the goal of this whole course - **using AI as a partner, with you in charge.**

What We Learned in this Session

Let's recap everything we covered in Session 1:

What AI Is

Computers doing things that usually need a human brain

AI is Everywhere

Netflix, Siri, Snapchat, ChatGPT, Maps, and more

How AI Works

Sense → Think → Act - every time, every AI

AI vs. Humans

AI is fast and pattern-smart, but no feelings, no real understanding

Narrow vs. General

All AI today is Narrow - one thing at a time

The Big Rule

AI is a tool. **YOU are the boss.**

Your Homework: Create Your Own AI Story

Tonight, you're going to use AI on your own.

01

Open Google Storybook

At home - with a parent if needed

02

Make Your Own Story

Any topic, any direction - this one is all yours

03

Save It

Screenshot, copy the text, or save the link

04

Bring It Next Session

We'll share and celebrate what everyone made!

i About 15 minutes. Have fun with it!

Story starter ideas: A robot who loves to dance • A dragon learning to fly • A talking fish in the ocean



Upcoming Session : AI Concepts & Terminology 🧙‍♂️

Today we explored *what AI can do*. Next session, we'll learn the **special words** that experts use to talk about AI - the building blocks of the **AI!**



Algorithm

The recipe AI follows



Data

The examples AI learns from



Model

The trained AI, ready to use



Training

How AI learns from data



Prediction

AI's best guess



These are the building blocks we'll use throughout the rest of our AI journey. **See you next time!** 🙌🚀